Amistad | Student Worksheet

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Directions: Write brief answers. Use scenes to support analysis. No graphic descriptions are needed.

Before viewing

1. How is ending the slave trade different from ending slavery?

During viewing - Resistance and the defense

2. What does Cinque want after the Africans take control of La Amistad?

3. Why do the Africans end up in U.S. custody?

4. Name one claim made about the Africans or the ship. Who makes it?

5. Why does Baldwin need to establish where the Africans came from?

6. How does James Covey help the Africans and their lawyers?

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During viewing - Evidence and the courts

7. What does Cinque's account reveal about his capture? No graphic detail is needed.

8. How are the voyages on the Tecora and La Amistad different?

9. Name one political or diplomatic pressure on Van Buren's administration.

10. How does Adams connect the case to American ideals of liberty?

After viewing

11. What does the Supreme Court decide? Does this end U.S. slavery?

12. Choose one scene. Explain how it shows a struggle for freedom in 2-3 sentences.

13. What film detail would you verify? Name a historical source that could help.

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